

Lien Workflow Management Platform

Scope

Context and intent

We serve health plan clients that seek reimbursement for medical services they paid on behalf of members who are participating claimants in mass tort case. When those cases resolve in a settlement, a settlement administrator distributes funds, and our clients (health plans) are entitled to recover the share tied to the medical costs they paid. Our work is to assert and recover those dollars for each claimant, while coordinating with the settlement administrator that holds the data and issues payment. We do this across a book of many settlements and many health plans, and the value of the business sits in tracking every recovery opportunity accurately and carrying it to payment.

We want a vendor to propose how to implement this on a commercial SaaS application platform rather than building the surrounding scaffolding ourselves. The reason we favor buy over build is intentional because we want to inherit the platform's security posture, and we want commodity capabilities to come with the platform rather than being written by us: authentication, authorization and role-based access control, reporting, compliance controls, and system logging. We also will want a broader set of integration options to connect the third parties around us, upstream and downstream easily. As a result, we seek a platform that must be HIPAA compliant, is built with extensibility in mind, carry a low maintenance footprint, and allow custom code in a general-purpose language for the complex scenarios that configuration alone cannot express.

This platform will house an application to manage the lien workflow that encompasses our book of business. It keeps track of every lien, moves each one through its stages, records what happened and why, and coordinates the exchange of data with the third party settlement administrator so we recover the correct dollars. It calls purpose-built services for the sensitive proprietary work like coverage matching, the damages calculation, and financial movement of monies. We are holding a boundary of scope and abstracting those services to focus on the operational process of a lien first.

What a lien is and how it moves

A lien is our client's claim to be reimbursed out of a settlement. When a health plan has paid for a claimant's medical treatment, and that treatment relates to the injury at the center of a mass tort, the plan is owed part of that money back from the settlement the liable party funds. Each lien represents one claimant's recovery opportunity within one settlement.

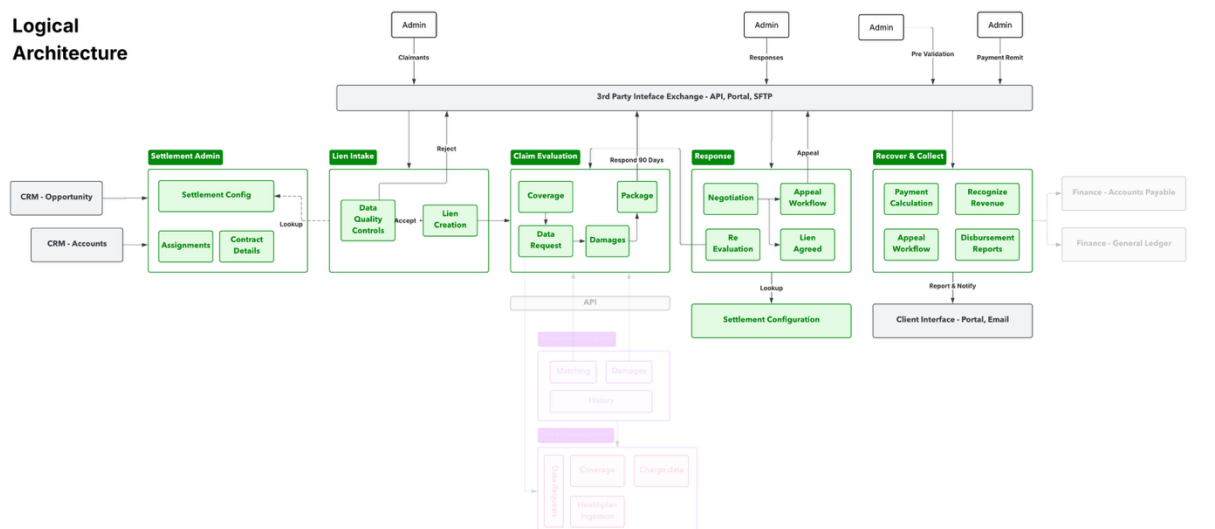
A lien is created when a settlement administrator sends us a claimant record that passes intake validation. From there it moves through defined stages. We establish that a participating plan covered the claimant, which is the liability question. We determine which medical charges are recoverable under the settlement's lien resolution program, which is the damages question. We assert that position back to the administrator within the response deadline the program sets, commonly 90 days. We negotiate to an agreed amount, confirm what is recoverable against state law and the plan's contract, and reconcile the payment when it arrives, down to the individual charge. Liens are long lived. One can stay open for several years and be re-

evaluated as new coverage or treatment information appears, so every evaluation and change is kept with its history.

High Level Functional Requirements

A defining characteristic of this application is managing the lifecycle of a lien, described below. There will be automated tasks, escalation processes & workflows that keep the liens moving through their states. One repeating pattern in this process is the constant exchange of information with an external party in receiving information, acting on it, and responding back. Our workflows will be triggered by data arriving from a settlement administrator and answered by data we send back to them. At most stages the platform receives an inbound trigger through SFTP, API, or a portal, runs the workflow that stage requires, and responds through those same channels with the result and the next step. This receive, process, and respond pattern is central to the system, and the platform must support it as a core behavior and functionality.

Logical Architecture



Within that pattern the application drives a lien through an order to cash lifecycle. Six capability areas define the flow:

- **Settlement Configuration.** System of record for a settlement, its participating health plans, its lien resolution program terms, and the readiness gate that must be met before liens can flow against it. Serves as the master configuration of how a settlement will operate, be calculated and be paid out.
- **Lien Intake.** Ingestion of claimant data from settlement administrators through portal, API, or SFTP. Validates against an agreed data quality contract, then automatically creates a new lien, updates an existing one, or escalates a row the rules cannot resolve. Lists arrive on the order of 100,000 claimants.
- **Claim Evaluation.** Calls the internal Liability and Damages services, records the coverage and damages results on the lien with full history, and produces the response returned to the administrator within the program deadline.
- **Settlement Response.** Manages the administrator's reply and the negotiation that follows, with authorized users keeping or removing charge items until both sides reach an agreed amount.

- **Recovery Calculation.** Reconciles the administrator's figure against our recoverable amount, governed by program terms, codified state legislation, and codified health plan contract terms. Routes disputed liens to a resolution path.
- **Collection and Disbursement.** Reconciles the remittance against the recorded agreed amounts at the charge level, calculates how our organization and the health plans get paid, produces the instruction Finance uses to move funds, and drives the lien to closure.

Note: There are additional directional requirements to each of these modules available if required.

Platform requirements

These are drawn from our initial business requirements of the lien process that describes current operations. We have named specific technologies only where an integration requires it, and we expect the vendor to recommend how their recommended approach meets each one.

- **Compliance and security.** HIPAA, 42 CFR Part 2, and applicable state law. Encryption of data in transit and at rest. A Business Associate Agreement will be required and recognized certifications such as SOC 2 or HITRUST that we can rely on to support our own audits.
- **Access control.** Both role based and attribute-based access control, so access can be set at a fine level across every data set according to the user. Support for enterprise single sign on and the standard enterprise access management capabilities. The result is that we can control who sees and acts on which settlements and which liens, granting each user only the access their role and attributes allow, on every action.
- **Audit and history.** A complete audit log record of who did what, when, and why, across every lien and every configuration change for a determined retention period.
- **Workflow management.** The process should, theoretically, be able to run fully automated, with an escalation path and a workflow available whenever an issue needs a person to resolve it. The platform must be fully configurable, with custom objects, fields, and supporting functionality to model the lien process, its stages, holds, exceptions, and escalation queues, and to assign work and track ownership and progress. Complex business logic can be defined based on the underlying data model and events within the platform.
- **Integrations.** A system that is straightforward to integrate with and to, through APIs, webhooks, and other integration components. Inbound claimant and file data by portal, API, and SFTP. Outbound file delivery and notification by API, portal, SFTP, or email. Connections to a CRM such as Salesforce for health plan and administrator records, and to the Finance system for allocation and remittance handoff.
- **Configuration as code.** The ability to express configuration as version-controlled packages, so deployments are automated and run through a controlled deployment pipeline.
- **Data handling at scale.** The ability to store, manage, and transact with 100,000 records at a time, and to persist millions of records related to a lien while holding performance. Validation of inbound data at the point of receipt, processing of large batches, and tracking of long running data acquisition jobs so a lien advance when its data is ready.
- **Reporting.** Out of the box reporting that describes the configured workflows, the book of business, and the operational health of the system, including throughput, cycle time, holds, and tracking against the program deadline, without standing up separate reporting infrastructure.

- **Reproducibility.** The ability to codify recovery rules, including state legislation, program terms, and reimbursement methodologies, in a versioned and effective dated way that can be tested and maintained as law and contracts change and be reproduced if required.
- **Extensibility.** The ability to extend the platform with custom code in a general purpose language for logic that configuration cannot express, and a defined approach for rules that do not reduce cleanly to deterministic logic.
- **External facing portals.** Secure, regulation compliant portals through which external parties can exchange information with us.
- **Operational footprint.** A managed platform with a low maintenance burden, so our team spends its time on lien specific logic rather than platform upkeep.

What we are asking the vendor to include in proposal

Please respond with a proposed approach, not a fixed bid, addressing the following:

Overview and demo of recommended platform. The platform or platforms you propose, mapped against the requirements above, stating where each requirement is met natively, met by configuration, or requires custom code.

Reference architecture. How the platform handles the receive, process, and respond exchange with third party administrators efficiently, since that interaction is central to this system. Show how sensitive data is kept managed, and how the platform supports the requirements.

High Level Prototype plan. How you would deliver a working prototype by end of year that carries a single lien from intake through collection, using SFTP only, with no other integrations. Milestones, assumptions, dependencies, and the main risks you see.

Team and engagement. Your team and roles, what you need from us, and how we work together through delivery. The engagement must include a business architect who works with our team to define and document the lien process so it can be implemented correctly. We consider that role essential to a successful build, not optional.

Cost and footprint. Licensing model, implementation cost, and the ongoing maintenance and operating footprint we should expect.

Path beyond the prototype. How the same approach extends to integrating third parties upstream, meaning settlement administrators and data providers, and downstream, meaning Finance and CRM.

Expected deliverables of an engagement

A set of minimum deliverables we are expecting as part of the engagement with a vendor:

- **An implemented prototype** in the chosen platform including each functional module where a lien can be moved from creation through collection including an SFTP integration.
- **Detailed business process** documentation, business rules, workflows and diagrams that supported the development of the platform through requirements
- **Solution Documentation** on the developed platform and supporting documentation to operate.

- **Required configuration, controls and evidence** to support regulatory requirements, certification and audits.
- **Custom code and modules** to support requirements deployed and version controlled.
- **A deployment process** from version-controlled repository through platform prod and non-prod environments.

Target outcome and phasing

We are taking a phased approach.

Phase 1, by end of this year 2026. A prototype that works a single lien from intake through collection, to show how the platform manages the lien and handles the exchange with an administrator. No integrations at this stage beyond SFTP.

Phase 2, first half of 2027. Production readiness to work liens from pre-validation through collection. Operational and client reporting available.

Phase 3, second half of 2027. Full e2e integration with the claim evaluation engines and lien intake. Integration of data quality controls and monitoring from 3rd parties.

*** Note: The prototype is intentionally narrow. It confirms the platform choice, the workflow approach, and the third-party exchange pattern. It is not meant to deliver the full book of business by end of year 2026*

Scope boundary

The Phase 1 prototype does not build the Liability or Damages services, does not include healthcare claims data management. Initially only uses SFTP with no other integrations. Those belong to later phases. Anything a vendor proposes beyond a single lien from intake through collection should be called out explicitly as optional and priced separately, so the year end goal stays in reach.

Appendix Logical Architecture

Logical Architecture

